

DANCE

OVERVIEW

In dance courses at the Grade 11 and 12 level, students continue to learn in, about, and through dance. The medium of expression is movement; the instrument is the human body. Dance education goes beyond the study of a repertoire of movements to offer an understanding of the principles and concepts that govern and define the art. Dance transforms images, ideas, and feelings into movement sequences through innovative choreographic insights. Learning in dance requires a balance of knowledge and skills, and a synergy between intellect, ability, and emotion. Engagement in dance can provide a context for understanding world issues and exploring a variety of cultures. The study and practice of composition provide students with the essential building blocks that support lifelong interest in, appreciation of, and curiosity about dance.

Students refine their kinesthetic awareness and use all of the elements of dance (body, space, time, energy, relationship) to create dance works that explore themes and express ideas and moods. Technique emphasizes the importance of physiological and safety factors while leading to a fuller use of the body and all its parts, stimulating creative and expressive abilities. Students use the elements of movement with increasing refinement, complexity, and variety. They also give attention to development of alignment, balance, correct breathing, flexibility, and strength in creating dance works and performing them safely.

The art of dance should be shared. Students develop performance skills through formal and informal presentations, helping them recognize and communicate both aesthetic and personal values. They learn about the dynamic relationship between process and product. Students also demonstrate an increased understanding of the role of dance in various cultures, societies, and historical periods. They refine their ability to evaluate the quality of performances by critiquing their own and others' work.

The expectations for courses in dance are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 15–17) to create, re-create, and present dance composition in a variety of contexts. Creative work in dance involves the realization of exercises, explorations, experiments, dance works, and productions through the refinement of abilities, skills, and competencies. Students demonstrate increased autonomy and innovation in their practice as both choreographer and dancer. They develop personal metaphor and demonstrate their depth of understanding of the creative process. They become increasingly familiar with the tools of stagecraft in dance presentations.

2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** The critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) involves applying rational and logical thinking to learning in, about, and through dance. Students demonstrate increasing autonomy and ability of all stages of the critical analysis process. They evaluate their own dance work and the work of others, reflect on how dance can enhance both personal well-being and community life, investigate artistic and social influences on dance, and explore possibilities for continuing engagement in dance.
3. ***Foundations:*** This strand encompasses the body of knowledge, understanding, concepts, conventions, and norms that create an underpinning and a context for dance as an arts discipline. Understanding how to move the human body and expanding its movement vocabulary helps students develop insight into how and why people dance. Students examine developments in dance history and dance conventions around the world. At the same time, they expand their awareness of the artistic environment with respect to matters of safety, ethics, and acceptable modes of conduct as an artist, performer, and critic.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.
The list of approved focus courses for Dance can be found at:
www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Dance, Grade 11

Open

ATC30

This course emphasizes the development of students' movement vocabulary relating to dance genres from around the world, and of their understanding of the elements of dance and the tools of composition in a variety of performance situations. Students will research and explain how physical, intellectual, and artistic skills developed in dance can be applied in a wide range of careers. They will apply tools and techniques throughout the process of creation and presentation, and reflect on how studies in the dance arts affect personal identity.

Prerequisite: None

A. CREATING, PRESENTING, AND PERFORMING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** use the creative process, the elements of dance, and a variety of sources to develop movement vocabulary;
- A2. Choreography and Composition:** combine the elements of dance in a variety of ways in composing individual and ensemble dance creations;
- A3. Dance Techniques:** demonstrate an understanding of the dance techniques and movement vocabularies of a variety of dance forms from around the world;
- A4. Performance:** apply dance presentation skills in a variety of contexts and performances.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use the elements of dance to develop and perform a series of connected dance phrases inspired by a source (*e.g., demonstrate “stages in the life” of figures from various Rodin sculptures; depict changes in an object from nature or the surrounding environment*)

Teacher prompts: “What other works of art could be a source for dance creation?” “If you think of this figure as moving in time, can you demonstrate what preceded this moment, and what you imagine happens next?”

- A1.2** create and perform phrases that combine the elements of dance in a variety of ways (*e.g., use body parts in a sequential and then in an isolated way while alternating levels with each movement; combine the elements of space and relationship in a diagonal movement by a tightly clumped group*)

Teacher prompt: “What happens when you change direction abruptly? What happens to your formation when you move forward, backward, or in a zigzag?”

- A1.3** use the elements of dance to produce and perform movement vocabulary through guided improvisation (*e.g., explore negative space within a small group in a variety of ways, collaboratively*

decide on revisions, and repeat the improvisational process several times until a sequence begins to unfold)

Teacher prompt: “What strategies help you remember movement ideas generated during improvisation for use in a dance piece?”

- A1.4** develop a variety of solutions to movement problems following specific guidelines in performance (*e.g., use juxtaposition, contrast, and/or repetition with a partner to broaden movement vocabulary*)

Teacher prompt: “What other manipulations can you include in the exploration to broaden the development of your movement material?”

A2. Choreography and Composition

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** use a variety of choreographic forms, structures, and techniques to create and perform a series of movement phrases (*e.g., use a theme and variation structure in a duet; create a group composition using movement motifs that communicate a response to a natural or built environment beyond the studio*)

Teacher prompt: “In what way will your chosen environment shape your movement patterns and the relationships of the dancers?”

A2.2 create a dance composition inspired by a source (e.g., *develop dance phrases suggested by Feathers and Fools by Mem Fox and Nicholas Wilton or The Great Kapok Tree by Lynne Cherry and use them as the basis for a longer composition*)

Teacher prompts: “Which illustrations, images, key words, and/or phrases from the story give you ideas you can use in your composition? Do they appeal to your visual imagination, or your sense of sound or rhythm?” “What is the story’s message? How can you translate that message into the language of dance?”

A2.3 use a variety of compositional approaches to express a range of ideas and moods through dance (e.g., *select evocative words from a poem and create movement vocabulary to communicate their meaning; compose a series of dance phrases to reflect the structure and express the mood of a piece of music*)

Teacher prompt: “Which compositional approaches will you use? Which ones are likely to be most helpful in exploring new ways to communicate through movement?”

A3. Dance Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 apply knowledge of the movement vocabularies of a variety of dance forms from around the world (e.g., *practise and demonstrate movements from ballet/jazz dance, modern/contemporary dance, and one or more world dance forms, such as the Anishinabe “jingle dress dance” and the Punjabi bhangra dance*)

Teacher prompt: “In what way does knowing about the cultural or historical origins of a dance form influence how you perform the vocabulary?”

A3.2 accurately reproduce timing and phrasing patterns found in a variety of dance forms from around the world (e.g., *correctly perform a syncopated movement phrase*)

Teacher prompts: “What visual or auditory cues do you use to help you execute a specific rhythmic timing in dance? Is music distracting or helpful to your timing?” “Are mirrors helpful or distracting when you are focusing on accurately learning the rhythm or timing of a phrase?”

A3.3 arrange and present multiple sequences using the dance vocabulary and technique from an identified dance form (e.g., *use the vocabulary learned in Limón technique to create a five-minute Limón technique demonstration for a Grade 8 class*)

Teacher prompt: “What aspects of the Limón technique will you focus on in your demonstration?”

A4. Performance

By the end of this course, students will:

A4.1 revise, refine, and polish movement execution and choreography (e.g., *use teacher and peer feedback to clarify their movement choices and intention; rework or change phrases/sections that need revision; polish the technical execution of movement, timing, and spacing*)

Teacher prompt: “Have you received feedback encouraging you to change movement phrases that you are really attached to? Do you understand the reasons behind the suggestions? How could you work with the suggestions to produce a solution you can feel good about?”

A4.2 use the tools of stagecraft to achieve specific purposes in dance presentations (e.g., *use lighting to create a particular effect on stage or in the studio*)

Teacher prompt: “What technologies can you use to create lighting effects for your dance piece if a lighting board and lighting instruments such as spotlights, striplights, floodlights, and follow spots are not available?”

A4.3 maintain an appropriate stage presence in rehearsals and performances (e.g., *demonstrate awareness of self and others, a strong sense of focus, and an appropriate frame of mind*)

Teacher prompts: “How is the quality of your dancing in rehearsals and performances affected when you are distracted? How is the quality of a performance affected when you are distracting others?” “How do the energy and attitude you bring to the rehearsal environment affect the overall performance of the group?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process to reflect on and evaluate their own and others' dance works and activities;
- B2. Dance and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how societies present and past use or have used dance, and of how creating and viewing dance can benefit individuals, groups, and communities;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and possibilities of continuing engagement in dance arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** use the critical analysis process to describe and compare a wide variety of dance forms (*e.g., identify and describe the movement vocabularies of two or more dance forms and explain what is different and what is similar within these forms*)

Teacher prompt: "Why does comparing one dance form with another help you understand each one more clearly?"

- B1.2** analyse dance works in terms of both their content and their fluency, artistry, or expressiveness (*e.g., identify technical details of alignment and placement in their peers' movement combinations and explain how they affect the fluency and expressiveness of their dance works*)

Teacher prompt: "How can identifying the details that give fluency to another person's movement combinations help you improve the fluency of your own dance works?"

B2. Dance and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** compare the characteristics of a world dance form and a social dance form and describe the role each has in its society or culture of origin (*e.g., Odissi and square dance*)

Teacher prompt: "How does traditional North American square dance resemble other kinds of folk dances? What are some ways it is different from other folk dances, past and present? How would you describe the differences between folk dance and other types of dance?"

- B2.2** explain how dance contributes to their personal growth and self-understanding (*e.g., develop a series of "Dance gives me..." statements that reflect how they benefit from dance activities within and outside of school*)

Teacher prompt: "What areas of your life are most affected by your learning in dance? In what ways? Are there any areas that are not touched by it?"

- B2.3** identify and describe different types of dance represented in a particular culture, and describe their purposes (*e.g., the characteristics of rain dances in ancient Egypt and their relationship to environmental factors, agricultural practices, and religious beliefs*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some environmental issues in the world today? Which of these issues could you comment on in a dance? How might your dance be enhanced if you studied how dances from other cultures addressed environmental issues?"

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify physical, intellectual, and artistic skills that are developed through dance, and explain how they can be applied to a wide range of careers (*e.g., identify occupations that require the type of discipline and patience needed to participate in ballet class*)

Teacher prompt: “What skills or personal qualities are developed through studying classical East Indian dance? What careers require similar skills or qualities?”

- B3.2** explain why it is important to support dance arts in their community (*e.g., explain how a local dance organization contributes to community life, and identify supports it needs to continue or extend its activities*)

Teacher prompt: “What would you include in a detailed plan to help meet the needs of a community dance organization? How would you implement that plan within the organization?”

- B3.3** develop and maintain a traditional or digital dance portfolio to demonstrate their learning in a variety of ways (*e.g., gather and organize materials and records that reflect their evolution as dance creators and performers*)

Teacher prompt: “How could you use the materials selected for your portfolio to create a ‘narrative’ about your learning in dance throughout the year? What story will your portfolio tell?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Physiology and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, the physiology of movement as it relates to dance;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the social, cultural, and historical origins and development of dance forms, including their influence on each other and on society;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of safe, ethical, and responsible personal and interpersonal practices in dance activities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Physiology and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify and describe practices that can enhance a positive body image and healthy lifestyle and contribute to successful achievement in dance (*e.g., making informed nutritional choices; avoiding substance abuse; recognizing negative patterns of behaviour; identifying and building on their strengths*)

Teacher prompt: “What are at least two positive things you can say about yourself? How do the positive comments affect how you see yourself when you look in the mirror? What kinds of positive comments have your peers written about themselves? How have the comments affected the mood or tone of the class?”

- C1.2** demonstrate an understanding of specific details of muscular anatomy as they relate to movement (*e.g., describe the relationships between flexors, extensors, adductors, and abductors; create a short warm-up exercise that demonstrates the relationships between the skeletal muscles in the upper and lower body; identify key surface and deep muscles in different parts of their anatomy and explain or demonstrate ways to maintain or increase their strength*)

Teacher prompt: “How are tendons and ligaments involved in the warm-up process? What movements are included in your warm-up? What muscle groups are used in each movement?”

- C1.3** demonstrate, and describe using correct terminology, movement repertoire from a variety of dance forms from around the world (*e.g., describe and perform capoeira movements such as banda, cocorinha, ginga, rasteira; create games or narratives involving both words and movements to illustrate dance terminology*)

Teacher prompt: “What are the key terms and vocabulary we have studied this year? What methods of memorization or demonstration might help you remember your dance terminology?”

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** describe the historical development of one or more dance forms (*e.g., the development of English folk dance; the evolution of contra dance into salsa dance as we know it today*)

Teacher prompt: “What are some effective ways you can communicate information about the evolution of the dance form(s) you are interested in?”

- C2.2** identify and describe ways in which dance is or can be used to reflect or comment on social questions in the local and/or global community (*e.g., research and report on the themes addressed by dance pieces such as Lamentation by Martha Graham, A Flock of Flyers by the dance/comedy group Corpus, and/or The Green Table by Kurt Jooss, and the techniques they use*)

to communicate their message; research and report on how companies such as CityDance Ensemble, TRIP Dance Theater, and ODC Dance use dance to comment on environmental issues)

Teacher prompt: “Which dance companies use dance as social commentary most effectively? Which of their approaches or techniques might you adopt for your own purposes?”

- C2.3** identify and describe similarities and differences in some dance forms from around the world and illustrate them through performance (e.g., do research to identify and compare some characteristic gestures and movements of Kathakali dance and Aboriginal dance, or tap and flamenco, and perform excerpts from these styles to demonstrate their findings)

Teacher prompt: “What are some of the characteristics of social dance from the 1960s? How do these social dance forms reflect the music of this era? What role does improvisation play in this type of social dance? Is improvisation used to make some kind of ‘statement’? If so, what kind?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** identify and follow responsible practices while creating, performing, and viewing dance (e.g., explain why it is important to avoid distracting or inappropriate movement while viewing others’ performances; give constructive and respectful feedback)

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important to watch other students perform without making comments while the presentation is in progress?” “How does having an inattentive, noisy, or restless audience affect your own performance?”

- C3.2** demonstrate collaborative and negotiating skills during rehearsal and performance (e.g., contribute their fair share to the creative process; show willingness to negotiate group roles such as motivator, scheduler, materials manager, project coordinator)

Teacher prompts: “What do you do to build trust and encourage people to contribute their ideas?” “Do creation or presentation processes work better when people feel that they have a specific role/function in the group?”

- C3.3** identify and follow safe and ethical practices in dance activities in both classroom and performance settings (e.g., help others to use equipment safely; maintain appropriate boundaries; show respect for the opinions of others during class or group discussions; explain why it is important to respect others’ choreographic and intellectual property; create, describe, and perform a presentation that shows how another person’s work can be incorporated without plagiarizing)

Teacher prompts: “What specific safety concerns do we need to be aware of during this activity? Would it be helpful to give each student a specific safety feature to be responsible for?” “What is the difference between imitating and plagiarizing? When might it be appropriate to use someone else’s idea or concept in your own work? What are some strategies you can use to imitate creatively, without plagiarizing?”